North Ridgeville heads for the Hills

Twin brothers Josh and Jeremy come through to headline scoring and rebounding in Rangers' 63-45 victory over Bay

Bob Daniels
The Chronicle-Telegram

NORTH RIDGEVILLE — Bay's usually sharp outside shooters weren't so hot Tuesday night.

Part of the reason was that North Ridgeville's defense zeroed in on them.

And when the outside shooters missed their shots, the Rockets didn't get many rebounds either.

That's because they didn't have two 6-foot-8 guys under the basket to gather them in.

The Rangers did — the Hill twins, Josh and Jeremy. These senior skyscrapers dominated the backboards and propelled the Rangers to 63-45 non-conference victory.

Dominated, 33-16. Jeremy Hill pulled down a dozen, Josh 11.

On top of that, the Hills led the Ridgeville scoring parade, Josh with 23 points, Jeremy with a dozen as the Rangers improved to 8-8 for the season. Bay, which has lost two straight after a big weekend upset of Avon Lake, dropped to 7-9.

"Going in, our absolutely biggest priority was we had to establish a defensive presence on their perimeter guys," said Ridgeville coach Mark Rechin. "I mean, it's a no-post offense. So they got five guards out there and we've got some big guys who have to stay with some of these guards.

"And their guards are all shooters," Rechin said. "So you have to be out there contesting that stuff. That was our No. 1 priority, our key to the game."

One wonders what might have unfolded had the Rangers not concentrated on Bay's perimeter. Even with the pressure, the Rockets drilled a half-dozen 3-point field goals in 15 attempts.

And had they not fallen so far behind — 15-3 in the first quarter, 25-12 in the second — the Rockets might have kept it closer. Tom DeVito, Jon Komperda and Nate Eaton each scored a trey in the second period when Bay made a little run. At one point, with 2½ minutes left in the half, the Rockets had closed the gap to 33-27.

It was a close as they got.

"They (the defense) did everything they were asked to do," the Rangers' Rechin said. "They did a really good job. We rotated really well, we knew who their key guys were, we were aware of everybody who had the ball and was on the floor for them. It was just a great defensive effort, I thought."

Josh Hill scored 11 of his points in the second period as Ridgeville took a 35-27 lead at the break. He scored six more in the third, when the Ranger defense limited Bay to just five points — Komperda's second 3-pointer and a layup by Bill Sisto.

Then Dave Winchell scored five points and Jeremy Hill four in the final eight minutes to put it away. Winchell finished with eight points.

"We're in kind of a selfish way right now," said Bay coach Dave Peters. "We have to learn that basketball is a team game. We've had some glorious games, some very nice games, but tonight wasn't one of them. We missed four open layups in the first half and for whatever reason there was an intimidation factor there."

Two 6-8 defenders maybe?

"We're not a team that takes the ball into the paint very much," Peters said. "I don't want to hear that the Hill brothers frustrated us and we couldn't run our offense. We ran our offense."

Ridgeville plays Pioneer Conference leader Strongsville on the road Friday night. Bay returns to Southwestern Conference action at Westlake.

BAY (45): DeVito 1 0-3, Stewart 0-1-1, Purses 2-1-5, Sisto 4-0-9, Teichman 0-0-0, Komperda 3-5-14, Bordine 2-0-4, Jackson 0-0-0, Eaton 4-0-9, Wenzell 0-0-0. Totals 16-7-45.
WESTLAKE (63): Andrews 0-0-0, Montgomery 0-2-2, Schroeder 0-0-0, Tyson 1-4-6, Jo Hill 9-5-23, Winchell 3-2-8, Everiss 2-1-6, Wisorski 3-0-6, Je Hill 5-2-12, Payne 0-0-0, Nelson 0-0-0, Sumella 0-0-0. Totals 23-14-63.

Bay	9	16	5	13	— 45
North Ridgeville	19	16	12	16	— 63

Three-point goals: Bay 6 (Komperda 3, Sisto, Eaton, DeVito), North Ridgeville 3 (Winchell 2, Everiss). **Rebounds:** (B) 16, (NR) 33. **Turnovers:** (B) 13, (NR) 14. **Personal fouls:** (B) 17, (NR) 16. **Fouled out:** None.
Junior varsity: North Ridgeville, 58-47.

Sabres key on strong start

First Baptist then holds off North Coast

Ray Cooney
The Chronicle-Telegram

ELYRIA — First Baptist jumped out of the gate quickly thanks, in part, to 13 first-half points from Russell Lake, then held off a late run by North Coast Christian for a 69-58 win.

The Sabres (6-11) sliced through the Warrior defense in the first half, hitting 17 of 27 field goals (63 percent) and four of six three-point attempts. First Baptist held North Coast to just 34 percent shooting before intermission and took a 40-26 lead into the locker room.

"We came out pretty flat," said North Coast coach Dan Hawks. "There's no doubt about that. They came out on fire. Believe it or not, we had a game plan, but that went out the door.

"We couldn't dig out of the hole."

First Baptist coach Ray Cox said his team needed to work on shooting percentage headed into tournament time. The Sabres had shot 32 percent from the floor prior to Tuesday's game.

"We have worked the last week-and-a-half and I think it's starting to pay off," said Cox.

But the Sabres' hot shooting did not roll over into the second half, as First Baptist hit just 7 of 25 after the intermission.

Down 46-30, the Warriors took a time out with 3:50 to play in the third quarter, and something clicked. A Josh Johnson 3-pointer, two three's from Carlos Carde and a pair of Carde two-pointers ended the quarter on a 13-4 Warrior run that cut the lead to seven.

Carde's streak of 10 straight Warrior points was part of a 21-point performance. Matt Bieri, battling the flu, scored 16 points, and Josh Johnson had 11 before fouling out.

The Warriors played man-to-man pressure defense after the break, which helped to cool off the Sabres' shooting percentage. The man pressure and a full-court press forced First Baptist to do a lot of things they didn't want to, including turn the ball over 16 times in the second half.

North Coast continued the roll early in the fourth, cutting the First Baptist lead to 54-50, but that was as far as the comeback would get. The Sabres ended the Warrior run with a 9-2 stretch of their own and made their free throws down the stretch to seal the game.

"That was a critical time to hit your foul shots," said Hawks.

Also critical to the First Baptist effort was senior forward Tim Anderson, who served as a constant while his teammates went hot and cold as they came on and off the floor. Anderson, playing all 32 minutes, was strong inside, grabbing 14 rebounds, scoring 17 points and dishing out four assists.

"A lot of time when we need good solid possessions we go to Tim (Anderson)," said Cox. "Tim has been solid all year. He stepped up big for us tonight."

Anderson's work on the glass held the Warriors to just one shot almost every time down the floor as the Sabres won the battle of the boards 36-28.

Lake, who finished with fourteen points, Anderson and Chad Bowman (15 points) were the Sabres scoring leaders. Bowman also contributed four assists.

North Coast will go home Thursday to take on Lake Ridge Academy and First Baptist is back in action at home on Friday against Orange Christian.

NORTH COAST (58): Mitchell 1-0-2, Carde 9-0-21, Wandert 0-2-2, Schmitt 2-2-6, Johnson 5-0-11, Bieri 6-2-16. **Totals 23-6-58.**
FIRST BAPTIST (69): Henry 3-0-6, Bowman 6-2-15, Young 2-5-9, Lake 4-3-14, S. Anderson 3-0-6, T. Anderson 6-5-17, Reaser 1-0-2. **Totals 25-15-69.**

North Coast	10	16	17	15	— 58
First Baptist	21	19	10	19	— 69

Three-point goals: North Coast 6 (Carde 3, Bieri 2, Johnson), First Baptist 4 (Lake 3, Bowman). **Rebounds:** North Coast 28 (Nodal 5, Johnson 4, Mitchell 3, Carde 2, Wandert 2, Schmitt 2, Cayalin 2, Jenkins, Bieri), First Baptist 36 (T. Anderson 14, Lake 6, Young 4, Henry 3, S. Anderson 2, Reaser 2, Bennett). **Assists:** North Coast 11 (Mitchell 6, Carde 2, Johnson 2, Nodal), First Baptist 14 (Bowman 4, T. Anderson 4, Young 2, Lake 2, Henry, S. Anderson). **Blocks:** North Coast 2 (Johnson, Bieri), First Baptist 1 (Bowman). **Turnovers:** North Coast 17, First Baptist 25. **Total Fouls:** North Coast 19, First Baptist 7. **Fouled Out:** Johnson, Schmitt.



LINDA MURPHY / CHRONICLE

THREE CHEERS: Olmsted Falls' Neal Saluja goes up for a basket past Strongsville's Brian Moehring, left, during Tuesday night's game. Saluja finished the game with three 3-pointers for nine points.

Falls KOs PC champs

Gansey's 30 points, 18 rebounds lead 'Dogs over Strongsville

Chris Assenheimer
The Chronicle-Telegram

OLMSTED FALLS — What was billed as a battle of quality heavyweights wound up being an early technical knockout.

With Olmsted Falls riding the momentum from a big opening quarter, the Bulldogs solidified their spot as one of the area's top dogs Tuesday night, turning back Pioneer Conference champion Strongsville 75-67.

Falls scored 15 of the game's first 19 points en route to a 24-10 first-quarter lead and 43-32 halftime advantage. The Bulldogs were never seriously challenged the rest of the way by a Mustang team that has already locked up the outright PC title and is considered one of the strongest squads in the area.

"That good start gave us a little confidence that we could play with these guys," said Falls coach Pat Donahue, whose Bulldogs improved to 11-4 overall. "I didn't know if we could beat these guys or not. Our big thing was to just go out and compete."

Both teams were playing without injured starters, the Bulldogs minus guard Armando Flores, and the Mustangs without big man Josh Tomsheck.

Strongsville (14-3, 11-0) sputtered out of the gate, watching Olmsted Falls begin the game on a 10-2 run, but the Mustangs had an excuse. They lost their starting point guard Nick Skully, who picked up his third foul a little over three minutes into the opening quarter after being whistled for a questionable charging foul on his second.

"I thought the second foul on Skully was a horrendous call," said Mustangs coach Joe Lynch. "It had a major effect on the early part of the game. I'm not taking anything away from Falls. They're playing great ball and they shot it well. We just dug such a big hole."

OLMSTED FALLS (75): M. Gansey 13-2-30, Stanton 4-0-9, Saluja 3-0-9, Terbeek 2-1-5, Reitler 6-3-17, Arcuri 0-0-0, Braddick 0-0-0, Mucha 0-0-0, S. Gansey 2-0-5. **Totals 30-6-75.**
STRONGSVILLE (67): Paoli 0-0 0, Skully 6-1-14, Hutter 4-1-9, Bokar 1-0 2, Koncz 1-0-3, Moehring 4 0-10, Ritter 0 0 0, Bossman 11-3-29. **Totals 27-5-67.**

Olmsted Falls	24	19	19	13	— 75
Strongsville	10	22	15	19	— 67

Three-point goals: (OF) Saluja 3, M. Gansey 2, Reitler 2, Stanton, S. Gansey (S) Bossman 4, Moehring 2, Skully, Koncz.
Junior varsity: Strongsville 56, Olmsted Falls 48.

Holding the shovel for Falls was, not surprisingly, senior Mike Gansey.

Gansey, who broke the school's career scoring mark earlier in the season and came in averaging over 26 points a game, led all scorers with 30 points, but it was on the glass where he stood out. The 6-foot 4 senior grabbed a game-high 18 rebounds despite being outsized by a Strongsville frontcourt that didn't feature a player under 6-4.

"To be honest with you, I didn't think he played that well offensively," Donahue said. "But he did a great job rebounding. They were bigger than us and can jump better than us. We needed that."

Gansey didn't go it alone. The Bulldogs got a big contribution from point guard Garry Reitler, who played in his third game this season after missing the first half of the year due to academic ineligibility.

Reitler sparked Falls in the opening quarter with a pair of 3-pointers, combining with Gansey to score 17 of the Bulldogs' 24 points. The senior finished with 17 points — 14 in the first half.

"He makes us a better team," Donahue said. "He's one of those kids that has total confidence in his game."

Reitler is just happy to be on the court again.

"It feels great to be back and take some of the leadership role," Reitler said.

Despite the quick start from Falls, Strongsville hung in thanks to 6-5 forward Bob Bossman, who carried the Mustangs in the first half, scoring 19 of his team-high 29 points.

Strongsville cut the deficit to five points at 37-32 before the Bulldogs scored the last six points of the half.

After Falls opened up a 58-40 advantage on a 3-pointer from Neal Saluja with 2:55 remaining in the third quarter, the Mustangs cut it to 14 and got within single digits early in the final quarter. But another Bulldog burst (6-0) pushed the lead back to 15 points.

"It was a game of runs," Donahue said. "They'd cut it to eight and then we'd kick it back up to 14."

Despite the height disadvantage Falls won the rebounding battle 32-39, with both teams committing 22 turnovers.

The Bulldogs were hot from the field for the duration, connecting on 56 percent (30-54) of their shots and 17 of 30 in the opening half.

Strongsville, which shot 47 percent (27-58) from the field, is just one of a number of top-notch non-conference opponents that the Bulldogs have had to deal with this season.

"It makes us so much better," Gansey said. "It just helps us a lot to play teams like this. We're playing our best basketball right now."

Olmsted Falls has won eight of its last nine games with the lone defeat coming at the hands of Avon Lake, which at 10-1, shares the top spot in the SWC with the Bulldogs.

Falls has two more conference games left, including Fairview at home Friday, before the rematch with the Shoremen on Feb. 23 at Avon Lake.

Whitney leads Dukes

Wellington senior scores 32 points

SULLIVAN — Colby Whitney's game-high 32 points, including two 3-pointers, led nine Dukes in the scoring column as Wellington (7-8) downed Black River (5-11) 68-58 in non-conference play.

Matt Hlavsa led the Pirates with 24 points and Kyle Clark added 12.

WELLINGTON (68): Varney 1-2-4, Adkins 1-0-3, Barlow 1-0-2, Verhoff 0-2-2, Senghas 1-0-2, Yates 1-1-3, Schoonover 3-3-9, Whitney 12-6-32, Jameyson 1-1-4, Gundert 2-2-7. **Totals 23-18-68.**
BLACK RIVER (58): Hlavsa 11-1-24, Verhoff 1-1-4, Skidmore 1-0-2, Miller 3-1-7, Clark 3-5-12, Taylor 3-2-8, Kushmeeder 0-1-1, Burras 0-0-0. **Totals 22-11-58.**

Wellington	13	12	19	24	— 68
Black River	12	12	14	20	— 58

Three-point goals: (W) Adkins, Whitney 2, Gundert. (BR) Hlavsa, Verhoff, Clark.

N.Olmsted 58, Fairview 44

FAIRVIEW PARK — Will Lytwyn had a game-high 19 points, including 12 points in the third quarter, to lead North Olmsted (8-8, 4-7 SWC).

NORTH OLMSTED (58): Novak 3-0-7, Lytwyn 7-2-19, M. Trapp 7-2-16, Kovalan 2-2-6, Maczka 2 0-4, S. Trapp 3-0-6. **Totals 24-6-58.**
FAIRVIEW (44): Filipic 5-3-13, Borish 2-0-4, S. Schuler 2-0-4, Nosko 0-2-2, Rosol 3-0-7, Lauffer 4-2-10, Wilbur 2-0-4. **Totals 18-7-44.**

North Olmsted	14	16	16	12	— 58
Fairview	18	6	10	10	— 44

Three-point goals: (NO) Novak, Lytwyn 3. (M) Rosol.
Junior varsity: North Olmsted 36, Fairview 33.

Central Catholic 80, Berea 71 (OT)

BEREA — The Ironmen outscored Berea 11-2 in overtime in non-conference action.

Paul Moviel, Will Vazquez and Kyle Zimmer scored in double figures for the Braves with 20, 15 and 10 points, respectively. Berea (7-9) had a total of eight baskets from beyond the arc.

CENTRAL CATHOLIC (80): Duncan 4-3-11, Cooper 9-2-22, Rudolph 1-2-4, Melton 9-1-21, Benjamin 9-0-18, Pearson 2-0-4. **Totals 34-8-80.**
BEREA (71): Avery 3-2-9, Vazquez 5-2-15, Zimmer 4-1-10, Moviel 6-6-20, Justice 1-0-2, Jackson 3-2-8, Weatherington 2-0-5, Burke 1-0-2. **Totals 25-13-71.**

Central Catholic	17	17	17	18	11	— 80
Berea	22	15	16	14	2	— 71

Three-point goals: (CCC) Cooper 2, Melton 2, (B) Avery, Vazquez 3, Zimmer, Moviel 2, Weatherington.
Junior varsity: Central Catholic 63, Berea 56.

Lincoln West 52, Midpark 49

MIDDLEBURG HEIGHTS — Cleveland Lincoln West led all the way and held off the Meteors' (5-11) late charge.

LINCOLN-WEST (52): Sias 1-1-3, Travis 5-2-13, Dinkins 5-0-10, Carabello 3-0-6, Orta 3-1-8, Wright 3-2-8, Garcia 1-0-2. **Totals 21-6-52.**
MIDPARK (49): Eaton 0-3-3, Syvuk 2-2-6, Pratt 1-0-2, Mollica 3-0-8, Smith 3-3-9, Coyle 5-1-11, Novak 4-0-8. **Totals 18-9-49.**

Lincoln-West	13	19	6	14	— 52
Midpark	10	10	9	20	— 49

Three-point goals: (L-W) Travis, Carabello 2, Orta. (M) Syvuk 2, Mollica 2.
Junior varsity: Midpark 56, Lincoln-West 42.

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BOYS BASKETBALL

GIRLS BASKETBALL

Longhorns wrap up MAC-8 title

18th championship for LW's Wittrock

ROCKY RIVER — Lutheran West's change to a zone defense in the second half paid dividends as the Longhorns defeated Columbia 45-37 in MAC-8 action Tuesday night.

The win gives the Longhorns the conference championship and is Lutheran West's 34th-year coach Karen Wittrock's 18th league title. She won 13 titles in the defunct Inland Conference and has won five MAC-8 titles.

Andrea Boriska led the Longhorns with 25 points, including three 3-pointers. Erin Frye and Heather Karl each had 11 points for the Raiders.

Lutheran West (15-3, 12-1 MAC-8) travels to Cuyahoga Heights on Friday night as Wittrock goes for her 550th career win. Columbia (8-11, 6-7 MAC-8) hosts Richmond Heights.

COLUMBIA (37): Evans 0-2-2, Robinson 1 0-2, Frye 4-2-11, Karl 5-1-11, Hollan 1-0-2, Sletancin 3-1-7, Coleman 1-0-2. **Totals 15-6-37.**
LUTHERAN WEST (45): Boriska 8-6-25, Iwais 1-0-2, Radke 1-0-2, Rasmussen 4-0-8, Schwandt 1-0-2, Feher 2-0-4, Janke 1-0-2. **Totals 18-6-45.**

Columbia	6	12	8	11	— 37
Lutheran West	8	7	15	15	— 45

Three-point goals: (C) Frye. (LW) Boriska 3.
Junior varsity: Lutheran West 37, Columbia 17.

First Baptist 59, North Coast Christian 29

ELYRIA — Dawn Saylor had a game-high 12 points to lead the Sabres.

First Baptist teammate Nicola Wilhelm joined Saylor in double figures with her 11 points. Anna Summers led the Warriors with 10 points.

The Sabres (12-5) host Orange Christian on Friday. North Coast Christian (5-8) hosts Lake Ridge on Thursday.

NORTH COAST CHRISTIAN (29): I. Huntley 1-5-7, Mo. Christofferson 1-2-4, Mo. Christofferson 2-0-4, N. Christofferson 1-0-2, Summers 2-6-10, K. Huntley 1-0-0-2. **Totals 8-13-29.**
FIRST BAPTIST (59): Taubler 2-0-4, Milam 1-0-2, Wacker 3-2-8, N. Wilhelm 4-3-11, Cawley 2-4-8, Saylor 4-4-12, Kis 2-0-4, M. Wilhelm 1-0-2, Dalton 4-0-8. **Totals 23-13-59.**

North Coast	8	6	11	4	— 29
First Baptist	12	18	16	13	— 59

Admiral King 53, Huron 46

HURON — Jamie King and Veda Jackson each had 10 points to lead the Admirals.

Admiral King (12-6) travels to Fremont Ross on Thursday.

ADMIRAL KING (53): Williams 2-4-8, Martini 2-0-4, Garcia 4-1-9, Salva 2-0-4, Jackson 5-0-10, Curry 4-0-8, King 5-0-10. **Totals 24-5-53.**
HURON (46): Borgett 4-1-9, Faunt 0-2-2, Spitler 1-0-2, Lively 6 2-14, Gibbs 2-6-10, Willis 1-0-2, Souter 3-1-7. **Totals 17-12-46.**

Admiral King	10	12	16	15	— 53
Huron	12	14	11	9	— 46

Junior varsity: Admiral King 64, Huron 48.

Western Reserve Academy 46, Lake Ridge 30

HUDSON — Western Reserve Academy took advantage of several late Lake Ridge turnovers and made 5 of 6 free throws in the fourth quarter in Private School League action. The Royals made just 6 of 23 free throws for the game.

Ruthie Wysor led Lake Ridge with 12 points and was joined in double figures by Kari Sommer with 10 points.

The Royals (2-14, 0-5 PSL) travel to North Coast Christian on Thursday.

LAKE RIDGE (30): Sommer 3-2-10, Wysor 4-2-12, Limmer 3-2-8, Whiteman 0-0-0, Wingfield 0-0-0, S. Francis 0-0 0. **Totals 10-6-30.**
WESTERN RESERVE ACADEMY (46): D'Anza 1-0-2, Kelly 3-3-9, Lam 3-0-6, Longazel 2-2-6, McClanahan 4-0-8, Shalowitz 2-0-5, Walters 5-0-10. **Totals 20-5-46.**

Lake Ridge	9	7	8	6	— 30
W. Reserve Acad.	8	9	10	21	— 46

Three-point goals: (LR) Sommer 2, Wysor 2. (WRA) Shalowitz.

Ashland 38, Vermilion 26

VERMILION — Maggie Keiffer had nine points to lead the Sailors in an Ohio Heartland Conference loss.

Vermilion (4-14, 1-10 OHC) travels to Orrville on Saturday.

ASHLAND (38): Eighinger 3-1-7, Witchen 2-1-6, Kaylor 4-3-11, Mallory 2-5-9, M. Elbash 1-2-5. **Totals 12-12-38.**
VERMILION (26): Keiffer 4-1-9, Frederick 1-1-4, Keifer 1-4-6, Turner 2-1-5, Davis 1-0-2. **Totals 9-7-26.**

Ashland	11	6	8	13	— 38
Vermilion	7	8	4	7	— 26

Three-point goals: (A) Witchen, M. Elbash. (V) Frederick.

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